GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

Session 4
A Goal Without a Plan is Just a Wish

When you meet with your mentor about setting goals, your discussion should be about taking control of your career. It's important to understand the bigger picture for why creating a career plan is so important. To some, it might seem like just an exercise to be done with. But if you want to distinguish yourself as someone who knows what they want and is determined to achieve it, a written plan is a requirement.

Achieving something as complicated as a successful career requires careful planning and periodic evaluation of progress to the stated goals. This begins with self-reflection – understanding your own motivations, interests, and values to help you plan a career that will motivate you to succeed.

By starting with what makes you happy, you can find jobs that align with your interests. After you create a career plan, you should identify periodic career goals. If you don't have specific measurements for success, how will you know when you have achieved it?

Our goals just like our plans can change. For this reason, we should periodically reevaluate our stated goals to determine if they are still relevant and make new ones, setting new standards for success.

Your goals should include:

Short-term goals: These are targets you will achieve in one year or less. Progress for short-term goals should be evaluated frequently. For example, set a goal to connect with 500 LinkedIn professionals and measure your progress weekly.

Long-term goals: These are steps toward your overall career objectives that will take more than one year to accomplish. Think about where you want to be in five years and ten years. Set a date in your calendar every six months to review and reevaluate these goals for relevancy and progress.

Think about this: We spend our entire working careers striving for success. Isn't it logical that we should dedicate just a few hours to planning this journey and determining how we will know if we are successful?

Ask your mentor about their career goals and how they have changed over time.